

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Internal Audit & GRC Director | Audit Committee Secretary
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Executive Profile

Strategic Internal Audit Director with **20+ years** of GCC experience building IPO-ready audit functions, designing internal control frameworks, and advising Boards and Audit Committees. Proven record of **zero material weaknesses** in pre-IPO SOX/ICFR readiness, **AED 7.7M+ commercial recoveries** through data-analytics-driven auditing, and deep expertise across **UAE corporate governance, SCA/CMA capital-market rules, RERA, UAE PDPL, GDPR, ESG frameworks, ISO 27001** and NIST CSF-aligned cyber assurance.

Selected Achievements

- Delivered **AED 7.7M+ total commercial recovery** via a Board-approved Python/Pandas Audit Intelligence Platform and continuous monitoring.
- Achieved **zero material weaknesses** in Kitopi's pre-IPO SOX/ICFR readiness program, validated by EY attestation.
- Earned the IIA's top **"Generally Conforms" QAIP rating**, including External Quality Assessment, at Al-Faisaliah Group.
- Led M&A due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition, uncovering SAR 15M undisclosed litigation exposure that influenced deal renegotiation.
- Scaled audit teams from **3 to 20 professionals** across multi-sector conglomerates, embedding data analytics and forensic methodologies.

Core Competencies

Governance & Board Advisory

- Audit Committee governance, charters & board reporting
- ERM, Risk Appetite Framework & corporate governance
- Tone at the Top, stakeholder alignment, external-audit liaison

Regulatory & Compliance

- Pre-IPO SOX/ICFR, COSO 2013, IIA Standards
- CMA, SCA, RERA, UAE PDPL, GDPR
- ESG reporting, AML/CTF fundamentals, ISO 27001/NIST CSF cyber assurance

Audit Methodology & Analytics

- Risk-based audit planning, RCMs, walkthroughs
- Continuous auditing, fraud investigation, root cause analysis
- Integrated auditing, control deficiency remediation, QAIP

Technology & GRC Systems

- TeamMate+, AuditBoard, ServiceNow GRC, ACL, IDEA, Power BI
- SAP & Oracle ERP auditing, NAVEX EthicsPoint
- Python/Pandas, ML risk models, ITGC, cloud & cyber assurance

Professional Experience

Principal, Internal Audit & Risk Advisory

Jul 2025 – Present

Veritux Consulting Network, Dubai, UAE

- Advisory practice delivering **fractional Internal Audit Director** services and board-level risk governance counsel to GCC mid-market firms during IPO readiness, restructuring and regulatory transformation.
- Built Internal Audit Charters, Audit Committee Charters and Audit Universes aligned with IIA Standards and Saudi CMA requirements.
- Deployed an ML risk engine over a SAR 500M+ real-estate portfolio, identifying procurement/payment anomalies that recovered SAR 3.2M annually.
- Designed a risk-based internal audit framework for a UAE property developer, reducing exposure to RERA enforcement action.

Director of Internal Audit & GRC | Audit Committee Secretary

Jun 2022 – May 2025

Kitopi, Dubai, UAE

- Held full functional accountability as Internal Audit Director; designed and implemented the pre-IPO SOX/ICFR program using COSO 2013 and formal risk-assessment methodology, achieving **zero material weaknesses** during EY readiness attestation.
- Managed the Audit Committee governance machinery – agendas, board-packs and minutes for 12+ annual sessions; presented control remediation updates to the Board and reinforced Tone at the Top on risk culture.
- Built a Board-approved **Audit Intelligence Platform** (Python/Pandas population testing engine), recovering AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralizing AED 4.5M in forward exposure (AED 7.7M total commercial impact).

- Designed and implemented ITGC frameworks covering logical access, change management and computer operations; directed group-wide cybersecurity and data privacy audits aligned with UAE PDPL and GDPR.
- Scaled the internal audit and IT security assurance team from inception to support the IPO program (3 auditors, 2 IT security professionals).

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk | Audit Committee Secretary

Nov 2016 – May 2022

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC), Riyadh, KSA

- Achieved the IIA's top "**Generally Conforms**" QAIP rating, including External Quality Assessment, confirming adherence to global IIA Standards across methodology and governance.
- Designed a Board-commissioned risk framework across a four-sector conglomerate; drafted and presented the annual risk-based Internal Audit Plan to the Board, securing 100% approval and 96% completion rate.
- Implemented COSO-aligned Enterprise Risk Assessments covering inherent and residual risks against the Board's stated risk appetite; consolidated Group-wide risk exposure to inform an insurance strategy overhaul that reduced premiums by 15%.
- Led M&A due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition, uncovering SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure that directly influenced deal renegotiations prior to closing.
- Reduced fraud losses by 82% and saved SAR 4.2M annually; designed and operationalized Key Risk Indicators (KRIs) dashboard and established department KPIs, maintaining a 95% management-action closure rate.
- Directed comprehensive Business Continuity and Disaster Recovery (BC/DR) audits across all sectors, strengthening conglomerate operational resilience.
- Managed a USD 450K co-sourced audit budget, including cybersecurity audits with PwC and KPMG; scaled the team from 3 to 20 professionals.
- Co-opted as Audit Committee Member for the Restaurant Sector (Feb 2021 – May 2022) to govern restructuring operations.

Manager, Internal Audit (Function Lead)

Mar 2014 – Oct 2016

McDonald's Saudi Arabia, Riyadh, KSA

- Pioneered a risk-based internal audit methodology, shifting the function from a compliance-centric model to a strategic, enterprise-wide risk assessment approach.
- Spearheaded operational audits, business process re-engineering and process improvement using root-cause analysis, raising planned-audit-hour productivity from 30% to 70% within one year and increasing overall audit coverage by 25%.
- Established robust corporate governance protocols and coordinated third-party risk assessments directly with McDonald's Middle East Development Corporation and McDonald's Global Corp.

Internal Audit Manager

Apr 2011 – Dec 2013

KPMG, Qatar

Assistant Vice President, Internal Audit

Mar 2010 – Apr 2011

BMA Asset Management, Karachi, Pakistan

Audit Manager

Dec 2004 – Oct 2009

Ernst & Young, Karachi, Pakistan

Education & Certifications

Education	Certifications
B.Com – Karachi University, Pakistan	CIA (IIA), ACA (ICAP), FCCA (ACCA), GRCP, GRCA (OCEG), COSO ERM Certificate
UK ENIC: ACCA UK Master's Degree	Risk Management (NYIF), Forensic Accounting & Fraud Examination (WVU), Machine Learning with Python (IBM), Disruptive Strategy (HBS Online)

Selected Publications

Outlet	Title
GRC Report	AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability
ACCA AB Magazine	Keeping Risk Registers Relevant
IIA Magazine	Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags
Corporate Compliance Insights	FCPA Programs Are Missing Nuances About How Bribery Works
ConsultancyME	The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy